

MAD MUSHROOM

A Digital & Social Media Marketing Case for a College-Town Pizza Brand

01

The Slice

Mad Mushroom is a small independent chain of full-service pizzerias serving college towns — primarily near Purdue in Indiana, with additional outlets in Kentucky. The brand owns a late-night, deal-driven, student-led occasion. Menus, postcards, and magnet mailers reinforce a hyper-local identity.

“ College Town. Late Night. Pizza. ”

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STATES

18 - 24

CORE TARGET AGE

3

ACTIVE CHANNELS

Target Today

The current target segment is the 18–24-year-old college student. A natural expansion exists into 18–28 — covering Purdue graduate and PhD students — and into the repeat-customer base, which benefits from established on-campus brand loyalty.

Competitive Set

Indiana: Hotbox Pizza · Papa John's · Domino's · Pizza Hut **Kentucky:** LaRosa's · Big City.

02

On Campus

Mad Mushroom currently runs paid ads on Facebook, Instagram, and Twitter — though spend is shifting away from Facebook as the Purdue clientele has migrated to Instagram. The monthly budget concentrates on Instagram Stories and Twitter, complemented by a print mailer program (menus, postcards, and magnets carrying deal codes).

Three Active Channels

FB

DECLINING SPEND

IG

PRIMARY CHANNEL

TW

LATE-NIGHT MOMENTS

Hyper-Local Opportunity

The single biggest under-played growth lever is hyperlocal content. Marketing in college towns rewards nuance — football weekends, finals weeks, individual student-org partnerships. A Purdue-specific page (alongside the corporate handle) lets the brand build campus equity and run targeted promotions on the calendar that matters to its audience.

“ Hyperlocal content + the VIP program are the two most under-used growth levers. ”

03

SWOT

A two-axis view of the brand and its social presence: where Mad Mushroom is strong, where it leaves value on the table, and what the next two quarters could unlock.

Strengths

- Established VIP / subscription program with exclusive deals
- Strong on-campus brand recognition at Purdue
- Late-night occasion ownership
- Active across three platforms

Weaknesses

- Over-reliance on declining channels (Facebook)
- Generic content across geographies
- No campus-specific page for the Purdue branch
- Limited hyper-local creative

Opportunities

- Instagram Reels growth + creator partnerships
- Fraternity / sorority / student-org activations
- VIP program activation through social
- Repeat-customer remarketing

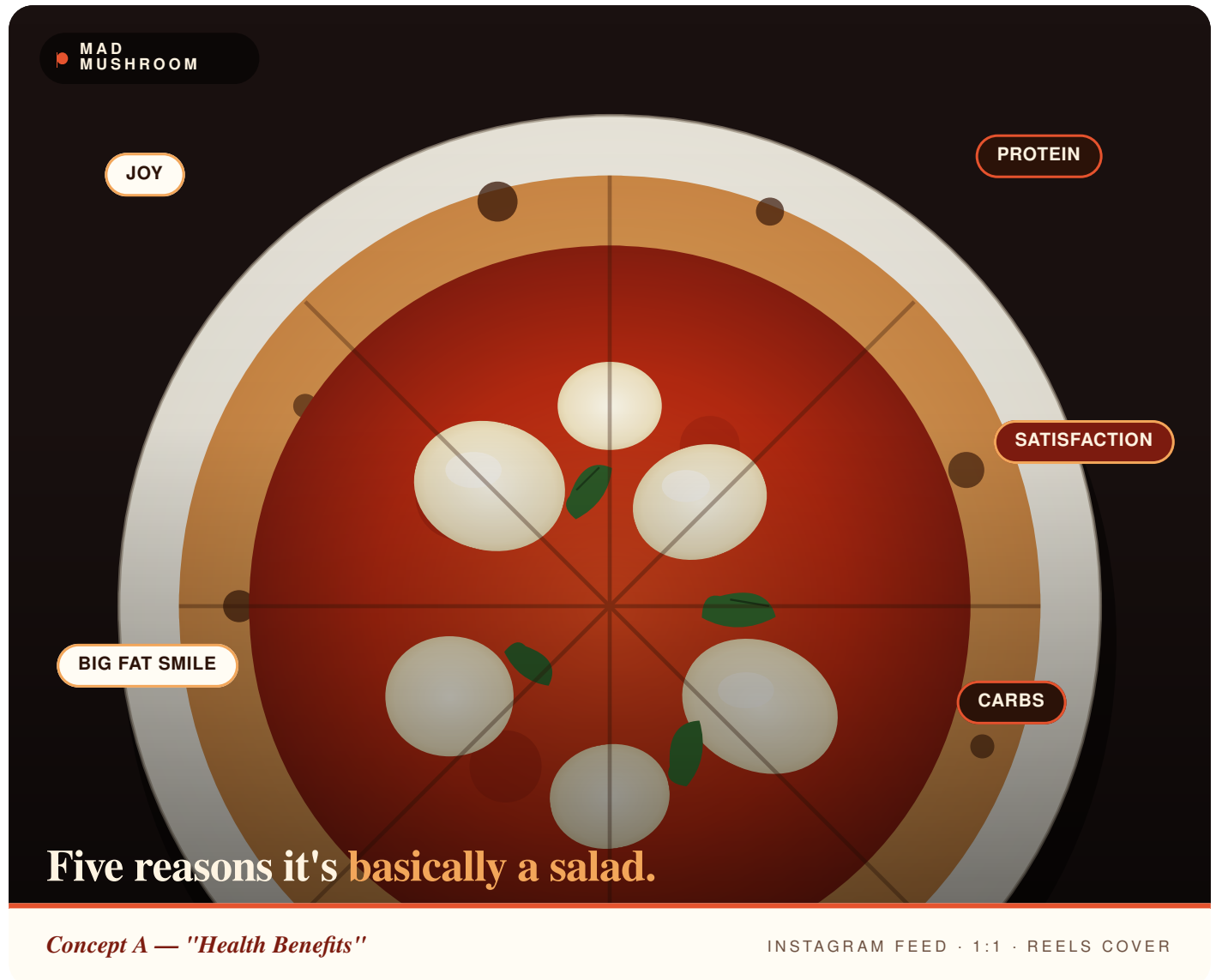
Threats

- National chains with bigger ad budgets
- Late-night delivery alternatives
- College-calendar seasonality
- Shifting Gen-Z platform preferences

PROPOSED CREATIVE · 01 OF 02

Health Benefits of Pizza

A tongue-in-cheek tile for Instagram and TikTok that reframes pizza as a wellness food. Five labels float over a hot margherita to spark a smile and a save.



INSIGHT

Gen Z scrolls past hard sells but saves anything that makes them laugh. A wellness-coded pizza is the joke that ends in an order.

FORMAT

Single feed image plus a 6-second Reel that animates each chip onto the pie one by one with a soft "ding."

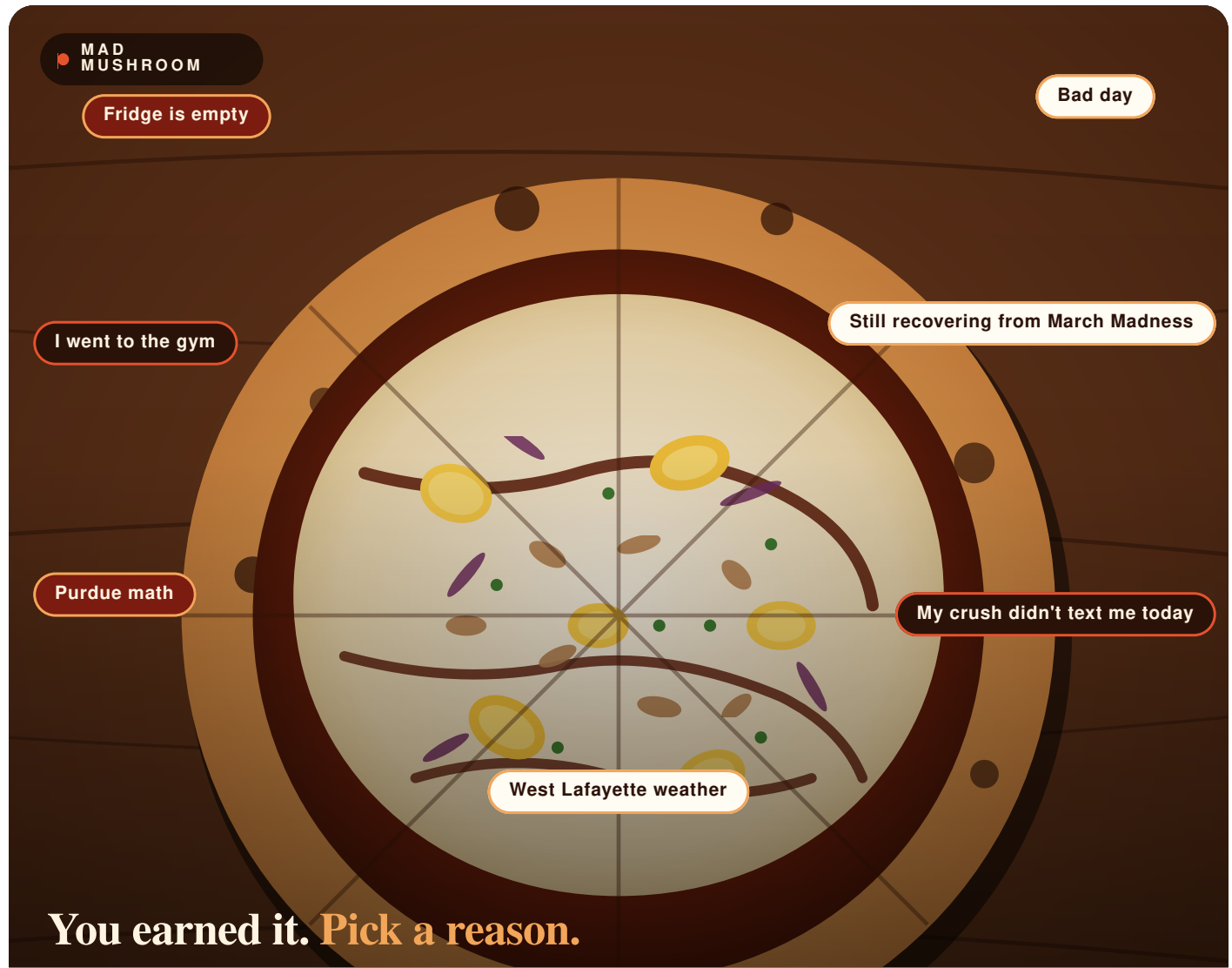
KPI

Save rate, profile visits, and direct DM mentions. We treat saves as soft conversions — every save is a future late-night order.

PROPOSED CREATIVE · 02 OF 02

Reasons You Deserve Pizza

A relatable rotation built for the West Lafayette feed. Each reason gets its own slot in a carousel — students see themselves, tap save, and order before the next class.



Concept B — "Reasons You Deserve"

INSTAGRAM CAROUSEL · 7 SLIDES · TIKTOK LOOP

INSIGHT

Students don't need a sales pitch — they need permission. Each chip is the validation they're already giving themselves at 11 PM.

FORMAT

Hero tile plus a carousel where each chip gets its own card. Locally specific (Purdue, West Lafayette) so it never feels generic.

KPI

Carousel completion rate, share rate (we expect peer-to-peer DMs), and same-night order conversion within 90 minutes of view.

05

Recommendations

Five priorities for the next two quarters — built around the two largest unrealised growth levers: hyperlocal content and the VIP program.

01 **Activate the VIP Program through Social**

Surface the subscription-based VIP deals more prominently on Instagram and Twitter to grow the list. Bigger list = better targeting + higher Top-of-Mind awareness + more conversions.

02 **Build Campus-Specific Social Pages**

Run a Purdue-specific Instagram alongside the corporate handle. Hyper-local voice during football weekends, finals weeks, and student-org events.

03 **Channel Reallocation**

Maintain Instagram as primary (Stories, Reels, creator partnerships). Cut Facebook investment. Hold Twitter for time-sensitive late-night moments.

04 **Creator & Student-Org Collaborations**

Sponsor a rotating set of micro-creators at Purdue. Co-host events with fraternities, sororities, and student orgs to lock in repeat occasions.

05 **Repeat-Customer Remarketing**

Build a low-touch lifecycle loop: VIP sign-up → SMS/email deal nudge → tracked redemption → upsell to bundles on busy nights.

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References

madmushroom.com

pagespeed.web.dev

[instagram.com/mad.mush](https://www.instagram.com/mad.mush)

twitter.com/madmushpurdue

facebook.com/MadMushroomPurdue